

System Hardening Report

Week 3 – Task 1

Focus: Disabling unnecessary services and securing open ports

Objective:

To enhance system security by disabling unnecessary services and ensuring only essential ports are open.

Actions Performed:

1. Checked Active Listening Ports:

- Used `netstat -tuln` and `ss -tuln` commands.
- **Result:** No open or listening ports were found, indicating minimal exposure.

2. Reviewed and Disabled Unnecessary Services:

- Used:
 - `systemctl list-unit-files --type=service | grep enabled`
- Stopped and disabled non-essential services such as:
 - `cups.service` (printing)
 - `avahi-daemon.service` (local discovery)
 - `bluetooth.service`, etc.
- Commands used:
 - `sudo systemctl disable <service>`
 - `sudo systemctl stop <service>`

3. Configured Firewall (UFW):

- Installed and enabled UFW:
- `sudo apt install ufw -y`
- `sudo ufw default deny incoming`
- `sudo ufw default allow outgoing`
- `sudo ufw enable`

- Status verified using `sudo ufw status verbose`.
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Result:

- The system is now hardened against unnecessary inbound connections.
 - All unnecessary background services have been disabled.
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